CLIENT COMMUNICATION & ENGAGEMENT ETHICS SOP

Standard Operating Procedure — Ethical Client Management, Onboarding & Service Standards

DOCUMENT OWNER	EFFECTIVE DATE	VERSION	CLASSIFICATION
Client Success & Sales	**October 2026**	**1.0**	**External & Client-Facing Policy**

1. POLICY PURPOSE & ETHICAL FOUNDATION

Our company is built on transparency, integrity, and client trust. This Standard Operating Procedure defines the ethical guidelines, response standards, and operational workflows governing all client interactions from initial contact through offboarding.

2. FIRST CONTACT, ONBOARDING & PROPOSALS

Every prospective client must experience a professional, structured, and transparent engagement lifecycle:

- **First Contact & Discovery:** Inbound client inquiries must receive an initial response within 4 business hours. A formal Needs Assessment meeting is scheduled to evaluate scope, constraints, and project feasibility.
- **Proposals & Quotations:** All proposals must provide a line-item breakdown of deliverables, hardware/software costs, estimated timelines, and explicit scope boundaries. Hidden fees or ambiguous pricing tiers are strictly prohibited.
- **Formal Onboarding:** Upon contract execution, the assigned Account Manager must issue an Onboarding Kit within 24 hours containing key contacts, communication channels, project timelines, and escalation paths.

3. RESPONSE STANDARDS, FOLLOW-UPS & MEETING MINUTES

Prompt, structured communication builds long-term confidence and prevents misalignment.

Interaction Type	Response Target	Mandatory Standard
New Client Inquiries	Within 4 business hours	Acknowledge inquiry; send calendar link for discovery session.
General Client Email / Ticket	Within 1 business day	Provide answer or status update with estimated completion time.
Urgent Service / Outage Call	Within 30 minutes	Immediate phone acknowledgment & route to Technical Ops lead.
Meeting Summaries (Minutes)	Within 24 hours of meeting	Email brief summary (Decisions Made, Action Items, Due Dates).

4. HONESTY IN PRICING, TIMELINES & DELIVERABLES

> **Core Ethical Requirement:** Over-promising to secure a contract damages reputation and violates company ethics. Staff must communicate realistic capabilities, transparent pricing, and honest timelines at all times.

- **Transparent Pricing:** All quotes must reflect true estimated costs. If unexpected scope changes arise, a formal Change Request (CR) specifying cost adjustments must be approved in writing prior to work commencing.
- **Proactive Delay Notification:** If a deadline risks slipping due to technical or third-party issues, notify the client immediately (minimum 48 hours before the deadline) with an explanation and revised delivery date.

5. CONFIDENTIALITY, BOUNDARIES & CONFLICT OF INTEREST

Safeguarding client data and maintaining clear professional boundaries is essential to maintaining ethical client relationships.

- **Client Data Privacy:** All client files, strategies, customer lists, and financial figures are strictly confidential. Staff must not share client details outside authorized project teams or use client data for personal gain.
- **Professional Boundaries:** Maintain a courteous, professional tone across all channels. Avoid personal financial dealings with clients or accepting gifts valued above $50 without management approval.
- **Conflict of Interest Disclosure:** If a team member has a personal, financial, or familial relationship with a client or competing entity, they must disclose it immediately to management to allow reassignment.

6. COMPLAINT HANDLING, ESCALATION & FEEDBACK COLLECTION

Client complaints must be treated as opportunities for improvement and resolved systematically through the following framework:

Escalation Level	Action Steps	Resolution Window
Level 1: Account Mgr	Direct discussion to address scope, communication gap, or minor service quality issue.	Resolved within 24–48 hours
Level 2: Department Head	Formal review of deliverables, process audit, and direct call with client leadership.	Resolved within 3 business days
Level 3: Executive Review	Executive involvement, corrective strategy adjustment, or contractual mediation.	Immediate priority action

Satisfaction Tracking (NPS / CSAT): Automated post-project surveys and quarterly CSAT check-ins are conducted to track satisfaction metrics. Any rating below 7/10 triggers an automatic Account Manager follow-up call within 48 hours.

7. ETHICAL CLIENT OFFBOARDING & TRANSITION

Whether a contract ends naturally or terminates early, offboarding must be executed with full professional grace:

- **Data Handover:** Provide the client with all deliverables, original assets, credentials, and documentation in an accessible format within 5 business days of contract end.
- **Data Retention & Purge:** Safely archive project files and securely erase sensitive client credentials or temporary access tokens according to our data retention schedule.
- **Exit Interview:** Conduct a brief exit conversation to gather honest feedback and maintain goodwill for future opportunities.

8. EMPLOYEE POLICY ACKNOWLEDGMENT

I confirm that I have read, understood, and agree to uphold all client engagement standards described in this SOP.

Employee Name: _____	**Manager / HR Rep:** _____
Signature: _____	**Signature:** _____
Date: _____	**Date Received:** _____